

THE MEMECOIN STARTER GUIDE

# Solana Memecoins for Complete Beginners

From zero to your first wallet, your first swap, and knowing what actually separates a real opportunity from a rug pull.

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This guide is educational only. It is not financial advice and it is not a promise of profit. Memecoins are one of the highest-risk categories in crypto — most of them go to zero. Only ever use money you can fully afford to lose.

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## Chapter 1

# What a Memecoin Actually Is

A memecoin is a cryptocurrency created mostly around a joke, a character, or a cultural moment rather than a piece of software or a company. Think of coins inspired by dogs, internet trends, or viral tweets. Unlike Bitcoin or Ethereum, memecoins usually have no underlying product — their value comes almost entirely from attention and speculation.

On Solana specifically, anyone can create a new token in a few minutes for a small fee. That's what makes the space so active — thousands of new tokens launch every single day. It's also why the overwhelming majority of them are worthless within hours.

### ■ RISK NOTE

The honest numbers: the large majority of memecoins launched lose most or all of their value, often within the first 24-48 hours. Trading them is closer to speculation than investing. Treat any amount you put in as money you're comfortable never seeing again.

So why do people trade them anyway? Because a small number of tokens do see genuine, fast growth early on, and traders who understand how to evaluate a token before buying can tilt the odds in their favor — even if they still lose on most individual trades. That evaluation process is what the rest of this guide focuses on.

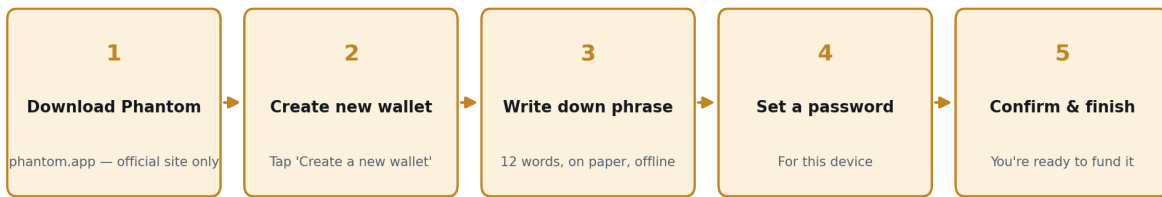
## Chapter 2

# Setting Up Phantom — Your Solana Wallet

Phantom is the most widely used wallet for Solana. It's what holds your SOL and any tokens you buy, and it's what connects to the trading platforms you'll use later.

## Step-by-step setup

- Go to [phantom.app](https://phantom.app) and download the browser extension (Chrome, Brave, or Firefox) or the mobile app from the official App Store / Google Play listing. Never download Phantom from a link sent to you — always type the address yourself.
- Click **Create a new wallet**.
- Phantom will generate a **Secret Recovery Phrase** — 12 words. Write these down on paper, in order. This is the single most important step in this entire guide.
- Set a password for the extension on this device.
- Confirm your recovery phrase when prompted, and you're in.



#### ■ RISK NOTE

##### **Your recovery phrase is the whole wallet.**

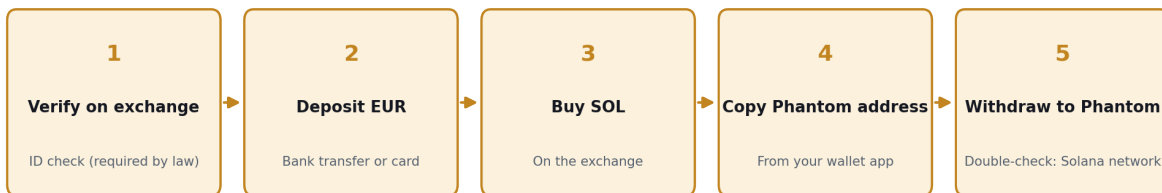
Anyone who has these 12 words can take everything in your wallet, instantly and irreversibly. Never type them into a website, a Telegram bot, a Discord DM, or share them with anyone claiming to be "support." Phantom staff will never ask for it. Store it on paper, offline — not in a screenshot, notes app, or email.

## Getting SOL Into Your Wallet

SOL is Solana's native currency. You need it for two things: to actually buy memecoins, and to pay small network fees (usually a fraction of a cent per transaction).

### The simple path

- Create an account on a reputable exchange (e.g. Coinbase, Kraken, Binance) and complete identity verification — this is a legal requirement, not optional.
- Deposit euros via bank transfer or card.
- Buy SOL on the exchange.
- Copy your Phantom wallet address (open Phantom → tap your account name/address to copy it).
- On the exchange, choose **Withdraw** → SOL → paste your Phantom address → confirm the network is set to **Solana** (not Ethereum or another chain — sending on the wrong network can lose your funds permanently) → send.
- Start with a small test amount the first time, confirm it arrives, then send the rest.



#### TIP

Keep a little extra SOL beyond what you plan to trade with — you'll need it for network fees on every swap, and running out mid-trade is a common beginner annoyance.

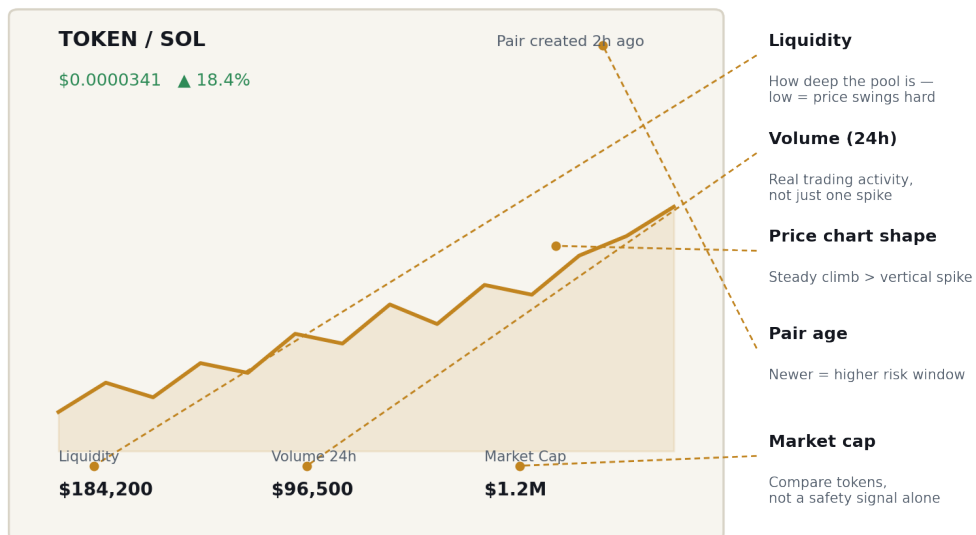
## Reading DEX Screener Like a Pro

DEX Screener ([dexscreener.com](https://dexscreener.com)) is a free tool that shows real-time data for every token trading on Solana (and other chains). It's where most of your research happens before you ever buy anything.

### The key numbers on any token's page

- **Liquidity** — the pool of funds backing the token, which determines how easily you can buy/sell without moving the price a lot. Very low liquidity means big price swings on small trades.
- **Volume (24h)** — how much has actually been traded recently. Healthy, steady volume across many wallets is a better sign than one giant spike.
- **Market cap** — the token's total value at the current price. Useful for comparing tokens, but not a safety signal on its own.
- **Price chart** — look at the shape, not just the direction. A slow, steady climb with normal pullbacks looks very different from a single vertical spike, which often precedes a crash.
- **Pair age** — how long the token has been trading. Very new pairs (minutes to hours old) are the highest-risk window.

Use the filters on DEX Screener's main screen to sort by chain (Solana), age, volume, and liquidity — this is how most traders narrow thousands of new tokens down to a handful worth actually looking at.



A simplified view of what to look for on a token's page.

## The Beginner's Checklist for a Healthy Token

No single check guarantees a token is safe — but the more of these boxes a token ticks, the lower the odds you're looking at an obvious scam or an already-dying token.

### ■ Liquidity locked or burned

Look for a liquidity lock (via a service like Team Finance or Unicrypt) or burned LP tokens. This means the creator can't suddenly pull the funds backing the token and vanish — the single most common rug-pull method.

### ■ Volume looks organic

Steady trading from many different wallets over hours, not one huge spike from a handful of wallets (which can be artificially generated, known as wash trading).

### ■ Top wallet concentration

Check the holders tab. If the top 10 wallets hold the large majority of supply, a few people can crash the price by selling at once. More spread-out ownership is healthier.

### ■ Contract renounced / no obvious backdoor

Renounced means the creator gave up special control over the contract (like the ability to mint unlimited new tokens or block people from selling). Tools like RugCheck or Solsniffer will flag common danger signs automatically.

### ■ Active, real community

Check the Telegram and Twitter/X — is it genuine conversation, or mostly bots and copy-pasted hype? A live, responsive team answering real questions is a good sign.

### ■ A working, real website

Even a simple site suggests some effort was put in beyond a five-minute token launch. Treat a missing or broken website as a caution flag, not a dealbreaker on its own.

#### TIP

Useful free tools to run through this checklist quickly: **DEX Screener** (price, volume, liquidity), **RugCheck.xyz** or **Solsniffer** (contract safety score), and the token's own Telegram/X for the human side of the check.

## Red Flags: How Rug Pulls Actually Work

Understanding the scam mechanics makes them much easier to spot in the moment.

## Liquidity rug pull

The creator removes the liquidity pool backing the token, instantly making it worthless and impossible to sell. This is why an unlocked liquidity pool is one of the biggest warning signs on this list.

## Honeypot

A token contract written so that buying is easy but selling is blocked or taxed at close to 100%. You'll only discover this when you try to sell. Contract-scanning tools like RugCheck flag most honeypots automatically before you buy.

## Pump and dump by insiders

A small group holding most of the supply hypes the token, waits for outside buyers to push the price up, then sells everything at once, crashing the price. This is exactly why checking top-wallet concentration before buying matters.

## Fake volume

Bots trading back and forth to make a dead token look active. A spike in volume with no real price movement or new holders is a common tell.

### ■ RISK NOTE

If something feels urgent — "buy now or miss it," countdown timers, DMs promising guaranteed returns — treat that pressure itself as a red flag. Legitimate opportunities don't need to rush you.

## Making Your First Swap

Once you've picked a token and checked it against the checklist, buying is done through a decentralized exchange like Jupiter or Raydium — both work directly with Phantom.

- Go to [jup.ag](https://jup.ag) (Jupiter) — it automatically finds you the best price across Solana's exchanges.
- Click **Connect Wallet** and select Phantom, then approve the connection in the Phantom popup.
- Select SOL as what you're paying with, and paste the token's contract address (copy this from DEX Screener — never trust a token by name alone, since scammers copy names).
- Enter the amount, review the price impact shown (a high price impact means low liquidity — reconsider the size of your trade), and confirm.
- Approve the transaction in Phantom. It should complete in seconds.



### TIP

Always paste the contract address from DEX Screener rather than searching by name inside the swap tool. Fake tokens using a popular name are extremely common.

## Position Sizing and Risk Management

This is the part most guides skip — and it matters more than picking the "right" token.

- Decide your total "memecoin budget" up front — money you're fully prepared to lose entirely — and never add more once it's gone.
- Split that budget across several trades rather than one large one. Most individual memecoin trades lose; a good process is judged over many trades, not one.
- Decide your exit before you buy, not after — at what gain do you take profit, and at what loss do you walk away.

- Consider taking your original investment back out once a trade is up, so you're playing with money that was already "the market's" gain, not your own capital.
- Keep a simple log of your trades and reasoning — it's the fastest way to actually improve instead of repeating the same mistakes.

■ **RISK NOTE**

No checklist in this guide eliminates risk — it only helps you avoid the most obvious traps. Never trade with rent money, borrowed money, or anything you need for real life.

# Glossary

**Contract address (CA)** — The unique ID of a token on the blockchain — use this, not the name, to find the real token.

**Liquidity pool** — The pot of funds (e.g. SOL + the token) that lets people buy and sell. Its size determines how much a trade moves the price.

**Liquidity locked/burned** — The liquidity has been made unable to be withdrawn by the creator, removing the most common rug-pull method.

**Market cap** — Token price × total supply — the total value of all tokens in circulation.

**Slippage** — How much the price is allowed to move between when you submit a trade and when it executes.

**Price impact** — How much your own trade moves the price — high impact usually signals low liquidity.

**Rug pull** — A scam where the creator drains the liquidity or otherwise makes the token worthless on purpose.

**Honeypot** — A token that can be bought but not sold, by design.

**Renounced contract** — The creator has given up special powers over the token contract.

**Wash trading** — Fake trading activity designed to make a token look more active than it is.

**SOL** — The native currency of the Solana blockchain, used for fees and to buy other tokens.

**DEX** — Decentralized exchange — a platform for swapping tokens directly from your wallet, with no company holding your funds.

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This guide is for educational purposes only and does not constitute financial advice. Cryptocurrency and memecoin trading carries a very high risk of loss. Do your own research and never risk money you cannot afford to lose.